Trescothick back then, when I was still bowling well before my radar would betray me. When Lara says goodbye here, though, I'm not pinching myself or grateful just to have bowled at someone like him any more, I'm thinking about the future and a changing of the guard. The future is unwritten, how can we make it ours?

In Galle for the third Test later that year against Sri Lanka, we are beaten by an innings. Myself, Stuart Broad and Graeme Swann are left out of the team. None of us are happy to be left out and, as we are running drinks to and from the field, getting on to the pitch as substitute fielders when needed, we try to find ways of making the day go quicker. When we are not needed, we play guess the song on the speakers, giving each other ten seconds to guess what song someone else is playing. There are quizzes and singing along while the team is getting soundly beaten. The team analyst, not joining in with it, informs Peter Moores that we haven't been taking our jobs seriously enough. Afterwards, in the team debrief, we are singled out and told we are to blame for the defeat. It's quite a thing to tell three people like us, desperate to play for England and growing into ourselves, convinced we can see a future in which England are more successful than ever. A little loyalty is formed between us – outsiders who are trying to get in.